

SCHOOLS OF VEDANTA (VEDĀNTA)

THREE VEDANTA ARCHITECTURES → ULTIMATE REALITY, LORD AND → WORLD, ILLUSION AND IGNORANCE → SUPERIMPOSITION AND GREAT STATEMENT → QUALIFIED NON-DUALISM → DUALISM AND FIVEFOLD DIFFERENCE

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

PRIMARY CORE FLOW SUBORDINATE EXTRA APPROVAL / REVIEW

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g3 and all prior artifacts unchanged

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

00

STAGE 00 THREE VEDANTA ARCHITECTURES

THREE VEDANTA ARCHITECTURES ONE UPANISHADIC CORPUS THREE METAPHYSICAL ARCHITECTURES NON-DUAL ULTIMATE REALITY; DIFFERENCE BELONGS TO IGNORANCE QUALIFIED UNITY; SELVES AND WORLD ARE REAL MODES GOD, SELVES AND WORLD ARE ETERNALLY DIFFERENT REALITIES ANSWER

COMPARE ONTOLOGY, CAUSATION AND LIBERATION ON THE SAME AXES

SYSTEM / DOCTRINE	DECISIVE DISTINCTION	EVALUATION / TRAP
ONE UPANISHADIC CORPUS → THREE METAPHYSICAL ARCHITECTURES	Visistadvaita: qualified unity; selves and world are real modes	ONE UPANISHADIC CORPUS → THREE METAPHYSICAL ARCHITECTURES
Advaita: non-dual ultimate reality; difference belongs to ignorance	Dvaita: God, selves and world are eternally different realities answer control: compare ontology, causation and liberation on the same axes	Advaita: non-dual ultimate reality; difference belongs to ignorance
SYSTEM / DOCTRINE - ONE UPANISHADIC CORPUS → THREE METAPHYSICAL ARCHITECTURES - Advaita: non-dual ultimate reality; difference belongs to ignorance	DECISIVE DISTINCTION - Visistadvaita: qualified unity; selves and world are real modes - Dvaita: God, selves and world are eternally different realities answer control: compare ontology, causation and liberation on the same axes	EVALUATION / TRAP - ONE UPANISHADIC CORPUS → THREE METAPHYSICAL ARCHITECTURES - Advaita: non-dual ultimate reality; difference belongs to ignorance

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Dvaita: God, selves and world are eternally different realities answer control: compare ontology, causation and liberation on the same axes.

01

STAGE 01 ULTIMATE REALITY, LORD AND SELF

ULTIMATE REALITY, LORD AND SELF ULTIMATE REALITY (BRAHMAN) LORD (ĪŚVARA) TRUE SELF (ĀTMAN) QUALITYLESS ULTIMATE REALITY; EMPIRICAL LORD UNDER ILLUSION PERSONAL QUALIFIED ULTIMATE REALITY WITH INSEPARABLE MODES

INDEPENDENT LORD AND PERMANENTLY DEPENDENT SELVES TRAP THE THREE SCHOOLS DO NOT USE THE SAME WORD

ULTIMATE REALITY (BRAHMAN) / LORD (ĪŚVARA) / TRUE SELF (ĀTMAN)		
Advaita → qualityless ultimate reality; empirical Lord under illusion	Visistadvaita → personal qualified ultimate reality with inseparable modes	Dvaita → independent Lord and permanently dependent selves trap: the three schools do not use
SOURCE / DOCTRINE - ULTIMATE REALITY (BRAHMAN) / LORD (ĪŚVARA) / TRUE SELF (ĀTMAN) - Advaita → qualityless ultimate reality; empirical Lord under illusion	ARGUMENT / MECHANISM - Visistadvaita → personal qualified ultimate reality with inseparable modes - Dvaita → independent Lord and permanently dependent selves trap: the three schools do not use the same word with the same ontology	IMPLICATION / VERDICT - ULTIMATE REALITY (BRAHMAN) / LORD (ĪŚVARA) / TRUE SELF (ĀTMAN) - Advaita → qualityless ultimate reality; empirical Lord under illusion

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: the three schools do not use the same word with the same ontology.

02

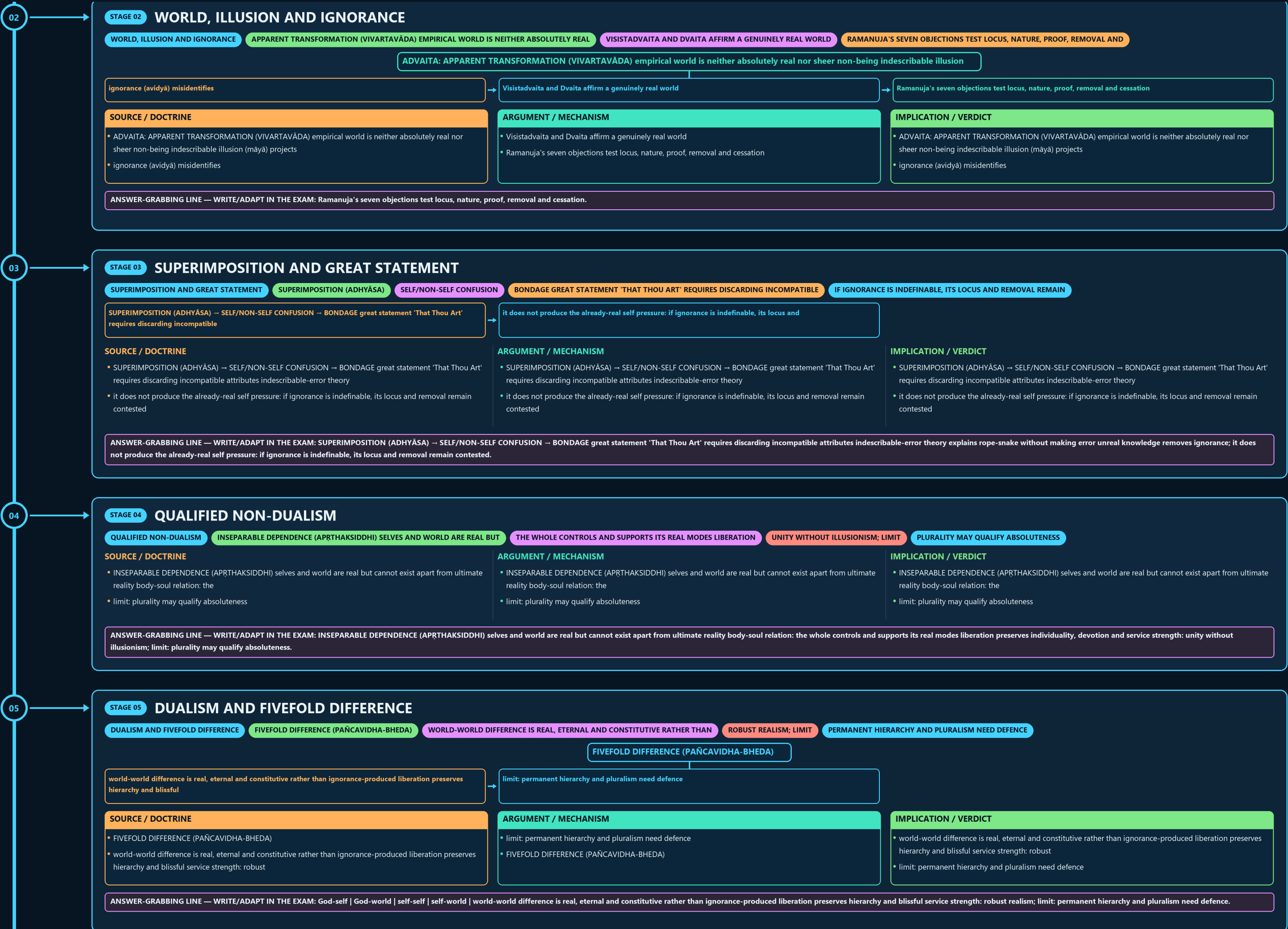
STAGE 02 WORLD, ILLUSION AND IGNORANCE

WORLD, ILLUSION AND IGNORANCE APPARENT TRANSFORMATION (VIVARTAVĀDA) EMPIRICAL WORLD IS NEITHER ABSOLUTELY REAL VISISTADVAITA AND DVAITA AFFIRM A GENUINELY REAL WORLD RAMANUJA'S SEVEN OBJECTIONS TEST LOCUS, NATURE, PROOF, REMOVAL AND

ADVAITA: APPARENT TRANSFORMATION (VIVARTAVĀDA) empirical world is neither absolutely real nor sheer non-being indescribable illusion

ignorance (avidyā) misidentifies	Visistadvaita and Dvaita affirm a genuinely real world	Ramanuja's seven objections test locus, nature, proof, removal and cessation
SOURCE / DOCTRINE - ADVAITA: APPARENT TRANSFORMATION (VIVARTAVĀDA) empirical world is neither absolutely real nor sheer non-being indescribable illusion (māyā) projects - ignorance (avidyā) misidentifies	ARGUMENT / MECHANISM - Visistadvaita and Dvaita affirm a genuinely real world - Ramanuja's seven objections test locus, nature, proof, removal and cessation	IMPLICATION / VERDICT - ADVAITA: APPARENT TRANSFORMATION (VIVARTAVĀDA) empirical world is neither absolutely real nor sheer non-being indescribable illusion (māyā) projects - ignorance (avidyā) misidentifies

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Ramanuja's seven objections test locus, nature, proof, removal and cessation.



05

STAGE 05

DUALISM AND FIVEFOLD DIFFERENCE

DUALISM AND FIVEFOLD DIFFERENCE

FIVEFOLD DIFFERENCE (PAÑCAVIDHA-BHEDA)

WORLD-WORLD DIFFERENCE IS REAL, ETERNAL AND CONSTITUTIVE RATHER THAN

ROBUST REALISM; LIMIT

PERMANENT HIERARCHY AND PLURALISM NEED DEFENCE

FIVEFOLD DIFFERENCE (PAÑCAVIDHA-BHEDA)

world-world difference is real, eternal and constitutive rather than ignorance-produced liberation preserves hierarchy and blissful

limit: permanent hierarchy and pluralism need defence

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

• FIVEFOLD DIFFERENCE (PAÑCAVIDHA-BHEDA)

• world-world difference is real, eternal and constitutive rather than ignorance-produced liberation preserves hierarchy and blissful service strength: robust

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

• limit: permanent hierarchy and pluralism need defence

• FIVEFOLD DIFFERENCE (PAÑCAVIDHA-BHEDA)

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

• world-world difference is real, eternal and constitutive rather than ignorance-produced liberation preserves hierarchy and blissful service strength: robust

• limit: permanent hierarchy and pluralism need defence

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: God-self | God-world | self-self | self-world | world-world difference is real, eternal and constitutive rather than ignorance-produced liberation preserves hierarchy and blissful service strength: robust realism; limit: permanent hierarchy and pluralism need defence.

06

STAGE 06

LIBERATION AND MAJOR CRITIQUES

LIBERATION AND MAJOR CRITIQUES

LIBERATION WHILE LIVING; IDENTITY DISCLOSED BY KNOWLEDGE

COMMUNION THROUGH DEVOTION AND GRACE

ETERNAL DIFFERENCE AND GRADED BLISS COMPARE SHANKARA, RAMANUJA AND

DOCTRINE / CLAIM

• ADVAITA → LIBERATION WHILE LIVING; IDENTITY DISCLOSED BY KNOWLEDGE

• Visistadvaita → communion through devotion and grace

OBJECTION / PRESSURE

• Dvaita → eternal difference and graded bliss compare Shankara, Ramanuja and Madhva

• through world-status and selfhood never collapse liberation into one generic Vedantic position

REPLY / RESIDUAL

• ADVAITA → LIBERATION WHILE LIVING; IDENTITY DISCLOSED BY KNOWLEDGE

• Visistadvaita → communion through devotion and grace

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Dvaita → eternal difference and graded bliss compare Shankara, Ramanuja and Madhva through world-status and selfhood never collapse liberation into one generic Vedantic position.

07

STAGE 07

PYQ ANSWER SYNTHESIS

PYQ ANSWER SYNTHESIS

DEFINE COMMON QUESTION

BUILD THREE-COLUMN CONTRAST

TEST OBJECTIONS ULTIMATE REALITY

LIBERATION USE ONE PRECISE DOCTRINE AND ONE RIVAL CRITICISM

UNITY, QUALIFIED UNITY AND DIFFERENCE SOLVE DIFFERENT PRESSURES

DEFINE COMMON QUESTION → BUILD THREE-COLUMN CONTRAST → TEST OBJECTIONS ultimate reality → Lord/self →

→ liberation use one precise doctrine and one rival criticism for each school state what

and what explanatory cost it pays qualified verdict: unity, qualified unity and difference solve different

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

• DEFINE COMMON QUESTION → BUILD THREE-COLUMN CONTRAST → TEST OBJECTIONS ultimate reality → Lord/self → world → ignorance/error

• → liberation use one precise doctrine and one rival criticism for each school state what each theory preserves

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

• and what explanatory cost it pays qualified verdict: unity, qualified unity and difference solve different pressures

• DEFINE COMMON QUESTION → BUILD THREE-COLUMN CONTRAST → TEST OBJECTIONS ultimate reality → Lord/self → world → ignorance/error

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

• → liberation use one precise doctrine and one rival criticism for each school state what each theory preserves

• and what explanatory cost it pays qualified verdict: unity, qualified unity and difference solve different pressures

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: unity, qualified unity and difference solve different pressures.

E

EXTRA

SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT

OPTIONAL DEPTH 1 — THE VEDANTA MAP

ULTIMATE REALITY (BRAHMAN), CAUSATION AND ADVAITA MEANS OF VALID

OPTIONAL DEPTH 2 — LORD (ĪŚVARA), TRUE SELF (ĀTMAN)

ORIGINAL, REFLECTION, MODE OR DEPENDENT SELF

OPTIONAL DEPTH 3 — WORLD (JAGAT) AND CAUSATION

APPEARANCE, DIVINE BODY OR REAL DEPENDENT WORLD

OPTIONAL DEPTH 4 — INDESCRIBABLE ILLUSION (MĀYĀ), IGNORANCE (AVIDYĀ)

OPTIONAL SOURCE WITNESS

• OPTIONAL DEPTH 1 — The Vedanta Map: Ultimate reality (brahman), Causation and Advaita Means of valid knowledge (pramāṇas)

• OPTIONAL DEPTH 2 — Lord (īśvara), True self (ātman) and Individual self (jīva): Original, Reflection, Mode or Dependent Self

• OPTIONAL DEPTH 3 — World (jagat) and Causation: Appearance, Divine Body or Real Dependent World

• OPTIONAL DEPTH 4 — Indescribable illusion (māyā), Ignorance (avidyā) and Superimposition (adhyāsa): How Advaita Explains Bondage

ADVANCED OBJECTION

• OPTIONAL DEPTH 5 — Liberation (mokṣa) Across Vedanta: Recognition, Communion, Service and Grace

• OPTIONAL DEPTH 6 — Ramanuja's Qualified Non-Dualism: Inseparable dependence (aprthaksiddhi) and the Body-Soul Model

• OPTIONAL DEPTH 7 — Madhva and Wider Vedanta: Five Differences, Nimbarka, Vallabha and Caitanya

• OPTIONAL DEPTH 8 — Great Upanishadic statement (mahāvākya) and Error:

COMPARATIVE NUANCE

• Tat Tvam Asi, Superimposition (adhyāsa) and Indescribable-error theory (anirvacanīya-khyāti)

• OPTIONAL DEPTH 9 — Absolutism, Inter-school Debates and the Critique of Vedanta

• OPTIONAL DEPTH 10 — PYQ Routing, Presupposition Ledgers and Answer Architecture

• The Taittiriya and Chandogya teaching of an ultimate source is therefore read through

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.